

The magnifying glass in their pocket.

Every iPhone has one built in. Switch it on, teach it in a minute, and leave them able to summon it **by voice** — for menus, mail, and the fine print on anything.

Set it up once

Switch it on once.

Settings → Accessibility → Magnifier → **on** (green).

Add it to Control Center.

Settings → Control Center → the green +.

Keep it on the Home screen.

Siri needs it there to open it.

Three ways to open it

“Hey Siri, open Magnifier.”

Easiest for most — no buttons to find.

Tap the Magnifier app.

A little magnifying-glass icon.

The Control Center button.

The reliable fallback when Siri mishears.

Teach it, don't perform it

Let their hands do the taps.

Doing builds the memory; watching doesn't.

Name each icon out loud.

“The gear,” not “tap there.”

Leave them the large-print card.

They'll re-read it after you go.

Using it

Point at the page, inches away.

Held like a magnifying glass.

Slide or pinch to zoom.

Two fingers if the slider feels fiddly.

Tap the flashlight when it's dim.

Brightens labels, menus, and mail.

Tap the round button to freeze.

Holds it still for a shaky hand.

Don't mix it up

Magnifier isn't Zoom.

Magnifier uses the camera; Zoom enlarges the screen itself.

Freeze beats a steady hand.

Capture once, then study it at leisure.

When it goes sideways

Siri hears “magnify her.”

Say it slowly, or use the Control Center button.

Can't find the icon?

Check it's switched on, and on the Home screen.

“Did I break it?”

You can't hurt anything here — reassure them.

Helping elders keep their independence — and giving their helpers the tools to do it well.